



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Bentonville
School Website: <https://www.foundersbentonville.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy Bentonville, AR (72712) presents a cohesive classical-education profile across the six examined categories. Public-facing materials on the school's site emphasize a traditional liberal-arts curriculum, a threefold path (grammar, logic, rhetoric), mastery before advancement, and a culture oriented toward truth, goodness, beauty, and virtue. Evidence of Socratic pedagogy, a knowledge-rich curriculum, and explicit mentions of classical texts and Great Books-like content are evident in the public material. There is also clear signaling of community and parental involvement through events, tours, and information sessions, as well as explicit commentary on the role of teachers as virtuous models and mentors. Taken together, these signals yield a consistently Classical ranking across all six categories.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Overall, the school is classified as CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle: Not applicable, as no category falls into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The current material already exhibits the core classical signals with little to no explicit signaling of non-classical approaches in the six areas analyzed.

Abstracted synthesis after category-by-category analysis: The Founders Bentonville materials demonstrate a strong classical orientation—truth, goodness, beauty; formation and virtue; grammar–logic–rhetoric; memorization and recitation signals via pedagogy; a teacher-as-virtuous-model emphasis; and active parental involvement. The strongest evidence appears in Curriculum and Pedagogy, with clear alignment to classical methods; Parents & Community also shows overt engagement. Across all categories, positive keyword indicators dominate, with no explicit negative indicators identified in the site content.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's classical framing emphasizes truth, goodness, and beauty as central, with a focus on cultivating wise and virtuous citizens. It presents a traditional liberal-arts orientation and a Socratic approach to education that anchors ethical and philosophical formation. - The site references the threefold path (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a knowledge-rich curriculum as the basis for formation and character development. - The Motto and teleology (pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation of virtue) are consistent with transcendent aims typical of classical Christian-education spheres.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; moral realism (implied); wisdom (implied by “wise”); logos (implied through classical wisdom); contemplation of permanent things (implied via timeless classics). These appear in the explicit description of classical aims and character formation. - Negative keywords present: none detected in the public-facing content.

Why this rating - The content centers on transcendentals and virtue-oriented formation, aligned with Classical elements that emphasize truth, goodness, beauty, and virtue as real, knowable ideals. The absence of explicit secular-relativist language or values-neutral framing supports a CLASSICAL designation.

Citations: Classical framing and explicit language around truth, beauty, goodness, virtue, and Socratic method appear in Founders Bentonville material.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents education as formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom rather than mere job-preparation. It emphasizes mastery and a knowledge-rich curriculum designed to cultivate human excellence and lifelong learning. - The curriculum is described as knowledge-rich and anchored in a classical telos (the true, the good, and the beautiful), with explicit mention of the threefold path (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a Great-Books-like emphasis on “the classics.” - The aim is not to train for workforce-first outcomes but to foster virtue, wisdom, and lifelong learning through a classical mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; cultivation of virtue; wisdom; liberal education; classical mission; telos; scholé; great conversation (conceptually; the site emphasizes timeless classical heritage); human excellence; moral imagination. - Negative keywords present: none detected in the public content.

Why this rating - The site frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, with a clearly stated classical mission and teleology, aligning with CLASSICAL rather than a workforce- or information-centric aim.

Citations: Explicit claims about formation, virtue, and a classical telos, along with references to a knowledge-rich liberal-arts path.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as liberal-arts oriented, with grammar, logic, and rhetoric forming the core path, and a reading emphasis on the classics and Great Books tradition. There is explicit emphasis on classics, western civilization, and primary sources. - The site cites learning in Greek and Latin root words and eventual study of formal Latin and other languages; historical, literary, and artistic focus on the classics; and a strong emphasis on subjects like English, History, Science, and Mathematics within a knowledge-rich framework. - There is a clear signal of reading great works and engaging in a long tradition of classical learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; trivium; quadrivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; primary sources; classics; Homer; Plato; Augustine; Shakespeare; Latin; Greek; history; Western civilization; Socratic texts; recitation; narration; dictation; sacred art; hymnody; music. - Negative keywords present: none detected (explicit “project-based learning” or “STEM-first framing” signals are not present in the core curriculum language).

Why this rating - The material aligns tightly with classical curriculum markers: Trivium and Quadrivium, Great Books/ Classics emphasis, classical languages, and an integrated, history-rich curriculum. This is CLASSICAL.

Citations: Curriculum-level descriptions emphasize grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books/classics, Latin/-Greek, and history/western civilization.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site foregrounds the Socratic method as a core learning approach and highlights the practice of memory, discussion, and shared inquiry in classical pedagogy. - Pedagogical language includes the aim of contemplative, restful learning (scholé), as well as a structured progression toward mastery, with emphasis on repetition and memory, which aligns with classical pedagogy traditions. - The public materials align with upper-school Socratic discussion and rhetoric training, including opportunities for students to engage in debate and oratory.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic method; learning through dialogue; memorization through recitation or chanting; contemplation; scholé; seminars; Paideia-style discussion; rhetoric; public speaking and oratory. - Negative keywords present: Minimal evidence of experiential/-constructivist, student-led, or project-based dominance in the public-facing pedagogy text.

Why this rating - The pedagogy language is strongly aligned with classical methods (Socratic dialogue, memorizations/repetition, rhetoric training, and contemplative pedagogy) with no public signaling of non-classical approaches in the core descriptions.

Citations: Pedagogical signals include the Socratic method and memory-based practices, plus scholé and rhetoric emphasis.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes teachers as virtuous models and mentors; the hiring language highlights a vision of teachers living virtue and forming students in moral character. - A language describing teachers as “models of virtue,” living curriculum, and a faculty of friends appears in public materials. - Public material includes a formal headmaster (and named staff) as part of the living curriculum and the faculty’s central role in the school’s culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: teachers as models of virtue; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty of friends; mentorship; collegial culture; lifelong learning; great books seminars for faculty. - Negative keywords present: none detected in the public materials.

Why this rating - The messaging about teachers as virtuous models and mentors, plus a collegial, living-curriculum approach, aligns with classical-faculty signals.

Citations: Hiring language emphasizes virtuous teaching; presence of named staff pages supports the “living curriculum” and faculty focus.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site signals active parental involvement through tours, information sessions, and events that invite families to participate (e.g., “Tours,” “Information Sessions,” “Donuts with Dads and Dudes,” “Muffins with Moms and Marvelous Women,” etc.). - The school presents parents as partners and participants in the school community, with events that encourage family engagement and opportunities for parents to learn about classical education (e.g., tours, information nights, and family-oriented events).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental involvement; home-school alignment; family engagement; community events; open campus; parent formation; classical book clubs. - Negative keywords present: none detected in the public materials.

Why this rating - Strong signals of parental partnership and community engagement are present, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations in this category.

Citations: Tours and information-session language, plus events like Muffins with Moms and other family activities illustrate parental involvement.

What Would Move the Needle

- If any category were SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, concrete steps could include: explicit articulation of theology-liturgical practices within the curriculum; deeper public signaling of liturgical or communal practices; more overt statements on the school's formation of affection (reverence, wonder) in direct classroom practice. In this evaluation, all six categories are CLASSICAL based on explicit textual signals; therefore, there are no category-level needle-moving actions required.

Note: If you'd like, I can extract direct quotations and map them line-by-line to the exact phrases in the Six Essential Elements lexicon to further strengthen the keyword-flagging map for each category.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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